

GOPI K KANCHARLA

Head of AI Platform Engineering · Enterprise AI Strategy & Governance · GenAI, Agentic & Cloud-Native Platforms · Financial Services

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linkedin.com/in/haigopi | Google Scholar – 28 Issued Patents (scholar.google.com/citations?user=cpw488YAAAAJ)
U.S. Permanent Resident (Green Card holder) · Open to relocation

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology executive with 20+ years leading enterprise platform, cloud, and AI/ML organizations across banking, automotive finance, and enterprise infrastructure. As Head of Technology at Toyota Financial Services, leads technology strategy, AI platform engineering, and enterprise modernization across commercial and consumer lending — designing scalable, fault-tolerant, cloud-native systems, and the AI platforms that run on them, with regulatory compliance, operational excellence, and high availability built in from the start. Architected a patented suite of explainable AI intelligence engines for real-time fraud detection, credit decisioning, and automated underwriting, and led an Amazon Bedrock-based contact center AI consolidation program that eliminated thousands of manual agent hours annually. Builds the platforms, guardrails, and governance patterns that move AI from pilot to production safely in highly regulated environments — treating explainability, model risk management, and resiliency as engineering requirements, not afterthoughts. Primary inventor on 28 issued patents (37 filed); founder of an AI-powered marketplace built on fine-tuned OpenAI models; trusted advisor to CIOs and SVPs. Mission: enable sustainable, responsible AI-driven innovation inside highly regulated financial services.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Enterprise AI Platform Strategy & Engineering | GenAI & Agentic Systems | Amazon Bedrock | LLM & RAG Architectures | AI Guardrails & Responsible AI Model Risk Management (SR 11-7 aligned) | Model Governance & Explainability (XAI) | MLOps / LLMOps | AI Model Lifecycle & Evaluation | Fraud Detection & Credit Decisioning
OpenAI Model Fine-Tuning | Open-Weight & Self-Hosted LLMs (Ollama) | Edge AI & GPU Inference (NVIDIA Jetson) | AI Cost Optimization & FinOps | Build-vs-Buy & Data Sovereignty Strategy
Cloud-Native Platform Engineering (AWS, Azure) | Distributed, Fault-Tolerant & HA/DR Architecture | API-First & Event-Driven Microservices | DevSecOps & CI/CD Automation
Regulatory Compliance (OCC, CFPB, FCRA, Fair Lending) | Cybersecurity, Risk & Data Privacy | Enterprise & Solution Architecture | Data Strategy & Governance
Global Engineering Leadership (120+ Engineers) | Managers-of-Managers | P&L & Vendor Management | M&A Technology Integration | Digital Transformation

SIGNATURE AI PLATFORM USE CASES

- Explainable Fraud & Credit Decisioning Engine** — Patented Autonomous Transaction Intelligence, Behavior Intelligence, and Narrative Reconstruction engines generate real-time, auditable “why” narratives for fraud detection, credit bureau pulls, and automated decisioning — replacing opaque scores, shortening analyst review cycles, and strengthening audit and model-risk defensibility.
- Enterprise Contact Center AI Consolidation** — Led an Amazon Bedrock-based program unifying fragmented communication channels into a single AI-assisted workflow, eliminating thousands of hours of manual agent effort annually.
- GenAI Developer Enablement & Cost Governance** — Built custom, reusable skills and tooling across the enterprise GenAI development stack, cutting token and licensing spend while raising developer throughput and output consistency.
- AI Guardrails, Model Risk & Responsible AI Governance** — Embedded explainability, model risk management, audit logging, and human-in-the-loop controls as engineering requirements — enabling AI to move from pilot to production safely across product, risk, compliance, cybersecurity, infrastructure, and operations.
- \$30B Commercial Loan Origination Platform Modernization** — Rebuilt the Loan Origination System from scratch in under six months; designed a configuration-driven UI engine that cut change cycles from one month to approximately five minutes.
- AI/ML Credit Risk & Cloud-Native Resiliency Platform** — Governed AI/ML models drove a 15% lift in approval rates and a 20% reduction in defaults; HA/DR-ready, multi-cloud architecture and DevSecOps automation tripled release velocity while cutting risk incidents 25%.
- Fine-Tuned LLM Nutrition-Facts Generation (Founder – VantaShala.com)** — Built an AI-powered home-chef marketplace that legalizes local chef businesses, with AI-enabled marketing and automated, label-ready nutrition-facts generation from fine-tuned OpenAI models.
- Self-Hosted Edge AI & Zero-Cost Inference (Personal Lab)** — Runs open-weight LLMs locally on NVIDIA Jetson Nano with Ollama — private, fully on-premise inference at zero recurring cost, applying the same hosted-versus-self-hosted economics that shape enterprise AI platform strategy.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TOYOTA FINANCIAL SERVICES — Plano, TX

Head of Technology – AI Platform Engineering, Banking & Commercial Lending, Consumer Lending | March 2025 – Present

- Lead technology strategy, AI platform engineering, and enterprise modernization across commercial and consumer lending; design scalable, fault-tolerant, cloud-native systems — and the AI platforms that run on them — with regulatory compliance, operational excellence, and high availability built in from the start.
- Architected and delivered a patented suite of intelligence engines — Autonomous Transaction Intelligence, Behavior Intelligence, and Narrative Reconstruction — generating real-time, explainable narratives for credit analysts across fraud detection, credit bureau pulls, and automated decisioning; reconstructs the “why” behind each decision instead of returning an opaque score.
- Led a contact center communication consolidation program built on Amazon Bedrock, unifying fragmented channels into a single AI-assisted workflow and eliminating thousands of hours of manual agent effort annually.

- Directed development of custom, reusable GenAI skills and tooling across the enterprise GenAI development stack, cutting token and licensing spend while raising developer throughput and output consistency — making GenAI adoption economically sustainable.
- Partner across product, risk, compliance, cybersecurity, infrastructure, and operations to build the platforms, guardrails, and governance patterns that let AI move from pilot to production safely, treating explainability, model risk management, and resiliency as engineering requirements.
- Directed a two-year technology modernization roadmap and delivered a new, scalable \$30B commercial loan origination platform serving critical dealer and commercial-finance journeys.
- Rebuilt the Loan Origination System from scratch in under six months; designed a configuration-driven UI engine that cut change cycles from one month to approximately five minutes.
- Built an AI/ML platform for credit risk and customer experience with governed model access and monitoring, driving a 15% lift in approval rates and a 20% reduction in defaults.
- Implemented AI governance controls and monitoring that ensured regulatory compliance and reduced risk incidents by 25%; tripled release velocity through end-to-end DevSecOps and API automation across multi-cloud infrastructure.

CAPITAL ONE — Plano, TX | February 2016 – March 2025

Director, Software Engineering – Marketing Technology & Analytics, Decisioning, Auto Finance | December 2021 – March 2025 (progressed from Senior Manager, Manager, and Master Software Engineer | 2016 – 2021)

- Progressed through four engineering leadership levels over nine years, building teams and developing managers and technical leaders across marketing, analytics, decisioning, pricing, and Auto Finance platforms.
- Set MarTech and analytics platform strategy that eliminated Adobe vendor lock-in, elevated data governance, and delivered \$240M+ in revenue impact.
- Built an AI/ML-driven Marketing Technology & Analytics platform supporting real-time personalization, targeting, and measurable engagement outcomes across millions of customer interactions.
- Delivered consumer loan origination decisioning systems and multi-lending & pricing platforms connecting business policy, data, models, APIs, and digital experiences.
- Established engineering standards, governance frameworks, KPIs, SLOs, and cross-functional delivery rhythms; managed budgets, vendors, and technical risk across multiple portfolios.

DELL EMC / EMC CORPORATION — Berkeley Heights, NJ | May 2011 – January 2016

Senior Cloud Software Architect / Engineering Leader

- Designed and led architecture for ECS, ViPR & UIM — hybrid cloud storage products adopted by global enterprises.
- Designed scalable, fault-tolerant, highly available, DR-ready cloud architecture; led \$11M multi-year programs against a two-year roadmap.
- Earned 28 of 37 filed patents as primary inventor for distributed systems, cloud storage, and automation innovation.

IPC SYSTEMS INC. — Fairfield, CT | October 2009 – May 2011

Frontend Engineering Leader

- Built next-generation trading platforms with real-time data and low-latency execution for capital markets; led a global team of 60+ engineers and established coding, design, and architectural standards adopted enterprise-wide.

EARLIER CAREER

- Adesa Inc. (Carmel, IN) — Lead Software Engineer, Jan 2008 – May 2009: Delivered full-stack applications for online vehicle auctions and inventory management across 12 vendor integrations; built ACG Express and Adesa's online auctioning systems.
- IBM (Bengaluru, India & Bari, Italy) — Technical Lead, Aug 2004 – Jan 2008: Built and led an offshore engineering team delivering enterprise applications using Java/J2EE, web services, and integration technologies.

FOUNDER, ADVISORY & APPLIED AI INNOVATION

GINGERKNIFE INC. / VANTASHALA.COM — Founder & Advisory Board Member

AI-Powered Home Chefs Marketplace – Legalizing the Local Home-Chef Business

- Founded and led an AI-powered marketplace connecting verified home chefs with consumers, building the compliance and verification workflows that legitimize and legalize local home-chef businesses under food-safety and regulatory requirements.
- Built AI-enabled marketing automation for chef onboarding, menu merchandising, demand generation, personalized recommendations, and customer engagement across the marketplace.
- Delivered automated AI nutrition-facts generation using fine-tuned OpenAI models — converting free-text recipes and ingredient lists into structured, label-ready nutritional data, removing a manual bottleneck and enabling regulatory-grade disclosure at marketplace scale.
- Owned product strategy, model fine-tuning and evaluation, cloud architecture, engineering execution, and launch as a 0-to-1 founder-operator.

ADDITIONAL VENTURES — Founder & Advisor

- RunningTicker.com — founded and scaled a financial analytics platform from zero to a successful exit. RentMitra Inc. — AI-powered rental marketplace with automated legal-agreement workflows. AlliBilli.com — all-in-one news platform designed for elderly users.

APPLIED AI RESEARCH & EDGE AI HOME LAB — Personal Projects

- Built and operate a self-hosted edge AI lab on NVIDIA Jetson Nano hardware, running Ollama to serve open-weight LLMs locally — delivering private, fully on-premise inference with zero recurring subscription or per-token cost.
- Hands-on across GPU-accelerated edge deployment, model quantization and right-sizing, local model serving and routing, retrieval-augmented generation, and inference cost tuning — maintaining current technical credibility from silicon to platform governance, and informing build-versus-buy, data-residency, and AI cost-management strategy at enterprise scale.

PATENTS, PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Patents: 28 patents issued (of 37 filed) as primary inventor in distributed systems, cloud storage, AI/automation, and resiliency — Google Scholar.

Writing: Founder & author, ThinkSpecial — 100+ articles on AI platforms, technology, and leadership.

Speaking: Cloud Expo International, DZone Live, Enterprise Executive Summit — talks on distributed leader-election algorithms, scalable cloud architecture, and AI platform strategy.

Advisory: Advisor to early-stage AI ventures; mentor for Women in Technology and STEM leadership initiatives.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S., Information Systems — Nagarjuna University, Guntur, India | **B.S., Computer Applications** — Nagarjuna University, India |

Certifications: AWS Certified Solutions Architect · SAFE · Java